CASCADIA ANALYTICS

Equinix, Inc.

Equity Research Note | EQIX | 28 OCTOBER 2026

Interconnection moat with pricing power

Equinix, Inc. screens as a Buy with a $1,024.45 blended target, 2% above the current price.

Analyst: Justin Wen

REFERENCE PRICE	BLENDED TARGET	BLENDED UPSIDE	
$1,007.66	$1,024.45	+2%	BUY

Investment Thesis

Interconnection moat with pricing power. Equinix is the critical internet exchange point where networks meet. Power constraints and data center moratoriums make competing hubs harder to build, turning existing campuses into indispensable assets that support a scarcity premium on cross-connects and cabinet space. Recurring revenue machine. Revenue is highly recurring, driven by space, power, and interconnection fees with historically very low churn. MRR per cabinet and interconnection adds compound steadily, and Q2

- Interconnection moat with pricing power
- Recurring revenue machine
- Fairly valued at the reference price

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The latest print

Recurring revenue machine. Revenue is highly recurring, driven by space, power, and interconnection fees with historically very low churn. MRR per cabinet and interconnection adds compound steadily, and Q2 2026 bookings accelerated 23% YoY on AI inference demand.

Fairly valued at the reference price. Our REIT AFFO-based DCF values Equinix at $1,022.89 per share in the base case (8% revenue CAGR, 51% EBITDA margin), with a probability-blended target of $1,024.45, roughly 2% above the $1,007.66 reference price. That lands inside our base-case Hold band; we rate the shares Buy on the operating-leverage path, with spot below the Bull case and operating margin expanding against revenue growth.

$2.63B	$11.78	51.1%	$5.16	~3.6x	$423M
Q2 2026 REVENUE	AFFO PER SHARE (Q2)	ADJ. EBITDA MARGIN (FY26E)	QUARTERLY DIVIDEND	NET DEBT / EBITDA	ANN. GROSS BOOKINGS (Q2)

Key metrics in detail

METRIC	LATEST	VS YEAR AGO	TREND
Q2 2026 revenue	$2.63B	+16% YoY	Accelerating
AFFO per share (Q2)	$11.78	+19% YoY	Up
Adj. EBITDA margin (FY26E)	51.1%	+2pp vs FY25	Expanding
Quarterly dividend	$5.16	+10% raise	Up
Net debt / EBITDA	~3.6x	Stable	Flat
Ann. gross bookings (Q2)	$423M	+23% YoY	Accelerating

The moat

Enterprise AI is moving from training to deployment; inference favors distributed, interconnection-rich campuses. Equinix reported ~60% of its largest recent deals tied to AI workloads, with annualized gross bookings up 23% in Q2 2026.

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The growth engine

Power constraints and local moratoriums make new competing hubs hard to build, giving Equinix pricing power on cross-connects and cabinet MRR. Existing campuses become more valuable as supply is capped.

Three scenarios make the valuation range explicit

Three scenarios frame the range; the blended target balances the three outcomes.

SCENARIO	2027-31 CAGR	2031 REVENUE	2031 EBITDA MARGIN	TARGET	UPSIDE
Bear	5.0%	$13.08B	48.0%	**$827.51**	-18%
Base	8.0%	$15.05B	51.0%	**$1,022.89**	+2%
Bull	11.0%	$17.26B	53.0%	**$1,224.51**	+22%

Bear: downside case at $827.51 (-18%).

Base: central case at $1,022.89 (+2%).

Bull: upside case at $1,224.51 (+22%).

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The probability-blended target implies 2% upside

The blended target implies +2% from the $1,007.66 reference price, balancing the Bear, Base and Bull outcomes in the scenario matrix.

$1,024.45
BLENDED TARGET

The valuation uses a multi-year discounted cash flow framework across three scenarios. Discount rates are market-implied and updated from live market inputs. The scenario matrix above states what each scenario assumes in growth and margin terms and what it produces: horizon revenue, enterprise value, equity value and the per-share target.

We judge a scenario by whether its growth and margin posture is supported by the filed record and the company's own guidance, and we disclose below how much of each scenario's value sits in the terminal year, because that share is where the valuation risk concentrates.

Reference price	**$1,007.66**
Bear target	**$827.51**
Base target	**$1,022.89**
Bull target	**$1,224.51**
Blended target	**$1,024.45**
Terminal value share of Base enterprise value	**78.5%**

BUY | $1,024.45 BLENDED TARGET | WEN

The reverse DCF: what the market prices in

The market-implied revenue CAGR is 7.6%, between Bear (5%) and Base (8%) — cautious.

Reverse DCF sensitivity

Implied enterprise value and share price at each five-year revenue CAGR. The highlighted row sits nearest the market-implied CAGR.

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CAGR	Implied EV	Implied price	CAGR	Implied EV	Implied price	CAGR	Implied EV	Implied price
-20%	$27.5B	$277.20	+0%	$71.7B	$722.09	+20%	$165.1B	$1,663.28
-19%	$29.0B	$291.66	+1%	$75.0B	$754.98	+21%	$171.7B	$1,729.02
-18%	$30.5B	$306.78	+2%	$78.3B	$789.13	+22%	$178.4B	$1,796.90
-17%	$32.0B	$322.59	+3%	$81.9B	$824.56	+23%	$185.3B	$1,866.95
-16%	$33.7B	$339.11	+4%	$85.5B	$861.32	+24%	$192.5B	$1,939.23
-15%	$35.4B	$356.37	+5%	$89.3B	$899.45	+25%	$199.9B	$2,013.80
-14%	$37.2B	$374.38	+6%	$93.2B	$938.98	+26%	$207.6B	$2,090.71
-13%	$39.0B	$393.18	+7%	$97.3B	$979.96	+27%	$215.4B	$2,170.02
-12%	$41.0B	$412.79	**+8%**	**$101.5B**	**$1,022.42**	+28%	$223.5B	$2,251.78
-11%	$43.0B	$433.24	+9%	$105.9B	$1,066.40	+29%	$231.9B	$2,336.05
-10%	$45.1B	$454.56	+10%	$110.4B	$1,111.95	+30%	$240.5B	$2,422.89
-9%	$47.3B	$476.78	+11%	$115.1B	$1,159.10			
-8%	$49.6B	$499.92	+12%	$119.9B	$1,207.91			
-7%	$52.0B	$524.02	+13%	$124.9B	$1,258.42			
-6%	$54.5B	$549.10	+14%	$130.1B	$1,310.66			
-5%	$57.1B	$575.20	+15%	$135.5B	$1,364.69			
-4%	$59.8B	$602.35	+16%	$141.0B	$1,420.55			
-3%	$62.6B	$630.58	+17%	$146.8B	$1,478.29			
-2%	$65.5B	$659.92	+18%	$152.7B	$1,537.96			
-1%	$68.5B	$690.41	+19%	$158.8B	$1,599.61			

Terminal value share

We disclose how much of each scenario value sits in the terminal year. Terminal value is 78.5% of Base equity value (Bear 77.4%, Bull 79.4%). A high terminal share means the target rests primarily on the terminal-year economics in the scenario matrix rather than on the explicit forecast years, and we weigh it accordingly in the investment view.

Fair value across scenarios

Model fair value by year under each scenario, on the same paths the ticker page chart draws.

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SCENARIO	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031
Bear	$827.51	$898.76	$929.79	$960.88	$991.89	$1,022.68
Base	$1,022.89	$1,110.96	$1,155.13	$1,198.51	$1,240.65	$1,281.06
Bull	$1,224.51	$1,329.94	$1,388.88	$1,446.13	$1,500.78	$1,551.80

Competitive moat and concentration risk

We rate the moat as Wide and we view the market structure as Duopoly (public data-center REITs). We assign a premium of +25 to +30% to sector median multiples on moat strength alone.

- interconnection network effects, 513,000+ interconnections across 281 data centers in 33 countries as of Q1 2026 (same profile), with Q2 2026 adding a record 9,700 net interconnections and interconnection revenue +13.5% year on year to $446M in Q1 2026 (Finsee Q1 2026 review). Each new network/counterparty inside an IBX raises the value of being inside it for everyone else.
- Q1 2026 stabilized recurring revenue +9% year on year with cash gross margin 71% (EQIX Q1 2026 earnings presentation); Q3 2026 guidance $2.525-$2.575B revenue (+9-11% year on year) and adjusted EBITDA $1.275-$1.315B (Zacks preview, Oct 2026). Recurring revenue above 90% of total (company profile, 2026) plus a 71% cash gross margin is the strongest pricing-power evidence in this batch outside ISRG.
- The weakest element is power and capital intensity, AI racks at 30-50 kW versus 5-10 kW traditional (Secure AI Factory coverage, Jun 2026) make growth dependent on securing power and funding heavy build, and hyperscaler self-build caps wholesale pricing.

On a multiple cross-check, the justified range is 26.4-27.5× / 41.7-43.4×. The cross-check value is $772.78-$803.69 vs Base $1,032.07, spot $981.67, P/E artifact, see warning, on a base of Framework base from the October 27 moat report. The gap verdict is n/a, Base above spot.

Backlog is About $15.0bn RPO, 30 Jun 2026, with coverage of 17.6 months vs 2026 guide midpoint and visibility rated High. On backlog alone, the stance is Supports.

We score concentration and credit risk across seven families, where a High score is 8 points, a Medium score is 4 points, and a Low score is 1 point.

Risk family	Score
customer concentration	1 points
counterparty credit and funding dependence	1 points
single product, single program, or single platform dependency	1 points
single supplier, single fab, or single geography exposure	4 points

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platform, channel, or distribution dependency	1 points
customer insourcing risk	4 points
regulatory single point risk	1 points

The combined discount is 13 percent, capped at 20 percent, against an uncapped total of 13 percent. Shown side by side with the moat premium or discount, the net stance is +12 to +17 pp points arithmetically. We do not net these figures into a new target, and we do not double count a family excluded under the double-count rule.

The ladder ranks risk coarsely, and because 32 of the 47 names reach the 20 percent cap, the combined discount is not a mechanical valuation haircut until the ladder is recalibrated.

On the gap to spot, the concentration assessment reads as follows. Arithmetic overshoot only; no causal claim

Both the moat premium or discount and the concentration discount are multiple and risk cross-checks dated October 27, 2026, and neither figure is in the DCF target itself. Cross-check figures were computed against the Base in the October 27 framework, so they may differ from a live Base that has since moved.

Methodology note. Our valuation framework discounts scenario cash flows at market-implied discount rates updated from live market inputs. The $1,024.45 headline target is the blended outcome of the Bear, Base and Bull scenarios in the matrix above.

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The franchise deep dive

Enterprise AI is moving from training to deployment; inference favors distributed, interconnection-rich campuses. Equinix reported ~60% of its largest recent deals tied to AI workloads, with annualized gross bookings up 23% in Q2 2026.

Power constraints and local moratoriums make new competing hubs hard to build, giving Equinix pricing power on cross-connects and cabinet MRR. Existing campuses become more valuable as supply is capped.

Interconnection revenue is mission-critical and sticky; migrating physical routing gear is costly, producing very low churn and high revenue visibility.

The 10% dividend raise to $5.16 quarterly underscores management's confidence in AFFO durability; the REIT structure mandates distribution of taxable income, aligning payouts with cash generation.

Revenue and margin trend

METRIC	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E
Total revenue ($B)	7.26	8.19	8.75	9.22	10.245
EBITDA ($B)	2.92	3.37	3.44	4.10	5.24 adj.
Diluted EPS ($)	7.67	10.31	8.50	13.76	N/A
Annual dividend ($/sh)	12.08	13.64	17.04	18.76	20.64

Valuation cross-check

REIT AFFO-based DCF: Bear $827.51 (5% CAGR, 48% margin), Base $1,022.89 (8% CAGR, 51% margin), Bull $1,224.51 (11% CAGR, 53% margin). Blended $1,024.45 vs $1,007.66 spot = +2% upside, inside the base-case Hold band; rated Buy on demonstrated operating leverage with spot below the Bull case.

Digital Realty (DLR) trades at higher AFFO multiples on similar leverage; Iron Mountain at a premium P/E. Equinix's interconnection density and ~51% margins justify a premium to wholesale peers, already reflected in its market cap ranking as the largest data center REIT.

Equinix has compounded revenue ~9% annually (FY22-FY25) with expanding margins. The blended target sits below the 52-week high of $1,128.68 and above the low of $720.62; the current price reflects roughly 6.1% implied 5-year growth per our reverse DCF, between the Bear (5%) and Base (8%) cases.

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What to monitor

28 Oct 2026. Q3 2026 results after the close; consensus ~$2.57B revenue. Management commentary on AI inference pipeline and bookings momentum is the key read.

Ongoing. AI inference deal flow: nearly 60% of the largest recent deals were AI-tied; continued enterprise AI agent adoption drives distributed low-latency demand.

Quarterly. Dividend trajectory: 10% raise to $5.16 quarterly in 2026; sustained AFFO growth supports further increases.

Financial summary: income statement

YEAR	REVENUE	GROSS PROFIT	OPERATING INCOME	EBITDA
2021	$6.6B	—	$1.1B	—
2022	$7.3B	$3.5B	$1.2B	$2.9B
2023	$8.2B	$4.0B	$1.5B	$3.4B
2024	$8.7B	$4.3B	$1.6B	$3.4B
2025	$9.2B	$4.7B	$2.0B	$4.1B

Balance sheet

YEAR	TOTAL ASSETS	TOTAL LIABILITIES	TOTAL EQUITY	CASH
2021	$27.9B	$17.0B	$10.9B	$1.5B
2022	$30.3B	$18.8B	$11.5B	$1.9B
2023	$32.7B	$20.1B	$12.5B	$2.1B
2024	$35.1B	$21.5B	$13.6B	$3.1B
2025	$40.1B	$26.0B	$14.2B	$1.7B

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Cash flow

YEAR	OPERATING CF	CAPEX	FINANCING CF	FREE CF
2021	$2.5B	—	$414M	—
2022	$3.0B	$-2.3B	$857M	$685M
2023	$3.2B	$-2.8B	$211M	$436M
2024	$3.2B	$-3.1B	$1.7B	$183M
2025	$3.9B	$-4.3B	$1.3B	$-400M

Methodology note. Our valuation framework discounts scenario cash flows at market-implied discount rates updated from live market inputs. The $1,024.45 headline target is the blended outcome of the Bear, Base and Bull scenarios in the matrix above.

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Agency risk score 42 of 100: high agency risk, the value-trap profile

The score follows the website's Executive Alignment & Agency Risk model: insider ownership up to 40 points, open-market Form 4 flow over the trailing six months up to 30, and pay-for-performance up to 30. Insiders hold 0.27% of shares outstanding. Form 4 filings over the trailing six months show $0 of open-market purchases against $20.42M of sales, a net flow of -$20.42M. One-year total shareholder return is +25.3% against CEO total pay of $1.24M (Ms. Adaire Rita Fox-Martin), which the model scores as PERFORMANCE EARNED.

42
AGENCY RISK SCORE, OF 100

The three components

COMPONENT	SCORE	WHAT THE SITE SHOWS
Insider Ownership (Skin in the Game)	2 / 40	0.27% of shares held by insiders
Form 4 Flow (Conviction Flow)	14 / 30	Buys $0 (0) vs sales $20.42M (13), net -$20.42M, trailing six months
Pay-for-Performance	26 / 30	PERFORMANCE EARNED: Stock Outperformance Matches Comp Structure. 1Y TSR +25.3%; Ms. Adaire Rita Fox-Martin, President, CEO & Director, total pay $1.24M
Agency Risk Score	**42 / 100**	Regime: HIGH AGENCY RISK // VALUE TRAP

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Recent Form 4 filings

DATE	FILER	RELATION	TYPE	SHARES	VALUE
2026-09-04	Paladin Michael Shane	Officer	SELL	307	$317.7K
2026-09-02	Paladin Michael Shane	Officer	SELL	203	$206.2K
2026-08-20	Pletcher Kurt	Officer	SELL	135	$145.2K
2026-08-18	Paisley Christopher B.	Director	SELL	125	$137.9K
2026-08-03	Paisley Christopher B.	Director	SELL	4,000	$4.08M
2026-06-08	Morandi Brandi Galvin	Officer	SELL	3,726	$4.01M
2026-06-02	Fox-Martin Adaire	Chief Executive Officer	SELL	2,935	$3.10M
2026-06-02	Lin Jonathan	Officer	SELL	150	$159.3K

SEC proxy audit, DEF 14A filed 2026-04-02

Alignment grade B. NO PAY CUT. Adaire Fox-Martin, fiscal 2025 vs fiscal 2024; total compensation change year on year: N/A.

BASE SALARY	STOCK AWARDS	NON-EQUITY INCENTIVE	OTHER COMPENSATION
$0	$0	$0	$0

The excerpt does not provide specific dollar amounts for CEO compensation, so a definitive shift cannot be quantified. The compensation mix indicates a heavy emphasis on equity and performance-based incentives, suggesting alignment with long-term shareholder value. No evidence of a pay cut or overpayment relative to performance is evident.

Proxy audit source: SEC EDGAR DEF 14A, audited 2026-10-25 by the weekly proxy pipeline. Filing: https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1101239/000110123926000073/eqix-20260401.htm

Methodology. This module reuses the website's Executive Alignment & Agency Risk model unchanged. Scores of 75 and above band as founder-mode, high conviction; 45 to 74 as balanced, typical corporate; below 45 as high agency risk. Inputs are the same feeds behind the site model (Yahoo Finance insider holdings, Form 4 transactions and executive compensation) plus the SEC DEF 14A CD&A audit from the weekly proxy pipeline. Computed 28 October 2026 for this note.

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The bear case

Rate sensitivity

As a leveraged REIT, Equinix's valuation is sensitive to the 10Y Treasury (currently ~5.1%). Sustained higher rates raise the cost of equity and the cost of funding expansion capex.

Power and permitting constraints

The same moratoriums that protect the moat can also limit Equinix's own expansion where grid capacity is constrained, capping growth in the hottest markets.

Leverage

Net debt of $19,050M (total debt $22,647M less cash $2,362M and current marketable securities $1,235M, on the house cash definition) is ~3.6x FY26E adjusted EBITDA. Refinancing risk is muted by long-dated fixed-rate debt, but the leverage limits flexibility if growth disappoints.

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The strengths

Operating Quality

Recurring interconnection revenue with ~51% adjusted EBITDA margin guidance, very low churn from high switching costs, and a network-effects moat deepened by data center moratoriums creating a scarcity premium.

Recent Trend

Q2 2026 revenue $2.63B (+16% YoY), AFFO per share $11.78 (+19%), annualized gross bookings $423M (+23%), full-year guidance raised twice, and a 10% dividend increase to $5.16 quarterly.

Forward Growth

AI inference workloads favor distributed, interconnection-rich footprints over AI factories; management notes ~60% of largest recent deals are AI-tied. Base-case 8% revenue CAGR with pricing power on cross-connects.

Valuation

DCF base target $1,022.89 and blended $1,024.45 imply +2% upside at the $1,007.66 reference price, inside the plus/minus 10% base-case Hold band; the Buy rating rests on demonstrated operating leverage with the price below the Bull case. Fairly valued on an AFFO basis with terminal value carrying most of the equity value.

Cascadia scorecard

Composite score 74: Attractive. Confidence High, as of 2026-10-18.

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PILLAR	RATIONALE	SCORE
Operating Quality	Recurring interconnection revenue with ~51% adjusted EBITDA margin guidance, very low churn from high switching costs, and a network-effects moat deepened by data center moratoriums creating a scarcity premium.	85
Recent Trend	Q2 2026 revenue $2.63B (+16% YoY), AFFO per share $11.78 (+19%), annualized gross bookings $423M (+23%), full-year guidance raised twice, and a 10% dividend increase to $5.16 quarterly.	80
Forward Growth	AI inference workloads favor distributed, interconnection-rich footprints over AI factories; management notes ~60% of largest recent deals are AI-tied. Base-case 8% revenue CAGR with pricing power on cross-connects.	78
Valuation	DCF base target $1,022.89 and blended $1,024.45 imply +2% upside at the $1,007.66 reference price, inside the plus/minus 10% base-case Hold band; the Buy rating rests on demonstrated operating leverage with the price below the Bull case. Fairly valued on an AFFO basis with terminal value carrying most of the equity value.	62
Catalysts & Risk	Near-term catalyst is Q3 2026 results on Oct 28 (consensus ~$2.57B revenue); continued AI-inference deal flow and dividend growth support. Risks: rate sensitivity as a REIT, power constraints on expansion, 3.6x net debt/EBITDA leverage.	68

Investment view

Sustained bookings growth above 20% with cross-connect pricing power intact would support a Bull-case rerating toward $1,224.51. A sharp rise in the 10Y Treasury or a slowdown in AI-driven bookings would compress the cost-of-equity valuation toward the Bear case near $827.51.

Investment view: Buy. The $1,024.45 blended target implies +2%, balancing the $827.51 / $1,022.89 / $1,224.51 Bear / Base / Bull outcomes.

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